lamps, lanterns or anything you've got. Rose, fill the tubs and pails and Amy and I will check on food, blankets and coats. Better get out the first-aid kit. Everyone make it snappy! *(Rose and Betty exit left. Jim turns to Amy.)* This is serious, Amy. I don't want to scare you, but your house is in the direct line of the river. If the dam has given 'way – *(He goes to the window.)* Well, if it has, you can see for yourself that it means we can't get out by the main road and we are already cut off from the south side. Look! *(He points out of the window. Amy joins him. She* gasps*.)*

Amy :
Jim! The water is up around the garage! I thought it was just a pool in the garden, but it's — it's...

Jim :
(Soberly) The river. Yes, Ay, that's old man river himself creeping up to your door. *(Jim and Amy watch it a moment. Amy* shudders*.)*

Amy : Oh, Jim, I'm scared!

Jim :
(Placing a hand on her shoulder) Steady, old pal! We've been through bad things before and come out safely. Remember the school fire? First thing, we must not let the others see how scared we are. Next, get all the things you can together here: water, food, blankets, coats, lights. I'm glad I served on the Junior Red Cross emergency squad during the war! It's too bad you live in a bungalow instead of a two-storey house, but we can always climb into the attic and onto the roof.

Amy :
(Still staring out the window) How fast is the river raising, do you think, Jim?

Jim :
I don't know and it might stop before it reaches us. If only the rain would let up! We will signal for help from the roof. They will send a boat or something.

Rose :
(Entering left) I've got enough fresh water to last us a week! Who will send a boat for us, Jim, and from where? *(She goes to the window, screams)* Horrors! Look at the river!

Amy :
Hush, Rose. Don't tell the others. Jim says we will be all right. Let's see what food we have on hand.

Betty :
(Entering left) Here are the lights. Did you say food? Hark, what's that? *(All four stand perfectly still, listening. From far off a child's voice is heard.)*

Sara : Ro-ose! It's me! Sara!

DO YOU KNOW?



If you experience an emergency of any kind, accidents or natural disasters anywhere in India, the number you should call is 108.

Book 1.indb 53 21-01-2020 17:28:06